

GALLERY DUTCH ART

The Art of Value

The practical workbook — turn art into measurable property value

gallerydutchart.nl

Turn art from a decorative afterthought into a measurable driver of property value — one exercise at a time.

*A hands-on workbook for hoteliers, developers, interior designers and asset managers. In the spirit of a *For Dummies* guide: plain language, real examples, and exercises you apply straight to your own project. By Gallery Dutch Art.*

Icons

• **Tip** · **Remember** · **Warning** · **Try It Yourself** (do these!) · **Template** (copy & fill)

How to use this workbook: Each module teaches a little, then hands you an exercise. Do the exercise on your own property before moving on. By the end you'll have an art narrative, a space-by-space plan, a budget, a shortlist and a KPI framework — the skeleton of a real art programme. Hands-on time: ~2–3 hours.

Module 1 — Why art is a business asset

For a century, hotel art was an afterthought — chosen last, to "fill the walls." The best operators now treat it as **positioning**: one of the few things a competitor can't copy. Art moves four commercial levers: **rate** (a distinctive property justifies higher prices), **dwell & spend** (guests linger and share), **earned attention** (press and social gravitate to a signature piece), and **asset value** (a curated collection strengthens the property as an asset).

Warning — the four budget-killers: buying art *too late* (costly retrofits), *decorating instead of curating* (pretty but forgettable), *ignoring lighting and scale* (great art, wrong wall), and *no narrative* (unrelated pieces). Avoiding these four is most of the battle.

Remember: Great art turns a beautiful building into a *destination*.

'Try It Yourself — The value case (10 min)

For your property, write one concrete sentence for each lever:

RATE: Art could justify a higher rate because _____
DWELL: Guests would linger/share in _____ if we placed _____
ATTENTION: Our "you have to see it" moment could be _____
ASSET: A curated collection would signal _____ to owners/buyers

Circle the lever that matters most to *your* business right now. That becomes your programme's north star.

Module 2 — Building your art strategy

Before choosing a single piece, decide the **story**. A beach resort whispering "barefoot luxury" needs a different art language than a city hotel signalling "power and culture."

'Try It Yourself — Your art narrative (10 min)

Template — Narrative

Property: _____
3–4 adjectives: _____
The feeling on arrival: _____
One sentence: "Our art makes guests feel _____ by _____."

Now map the **emotional arc** as a guest experiences it, and give each zone a job.

Template — Space-by-space plan

Arrival / lobby:	role = STATEMENT	scale = ____	mood = ____
Corridors/journey:	role = RHYTHM	scale = ____	mood = ____
Rooms & suites:	role = INTIMACY	scale = ____	mood = ____
F&B / social:	role = ENERGY	scale = ____	mood = ____
Spa / wellness:	role = CALM	scale = ____	mood = ____

Then set the money in **three tiers** *before* you fall in love with anything.

Template — Budget tiers

HERO pieces (1–3 unforgettable works): ~40–50% of budget = € ____
 SUPPORTING collection (coherent, guest areas): ~35–45% = € ____
 ACCENTS (smaller pieces): ~10–15% = € ____

Tip: As a rough hospitality benchmark, art often runs 1–3% of the FF&E budget — but the *hero* pieces deliver the disproportionate return.

Module 3 — Sourcing & curation

Know your options and what each buys you: **originals** (max prestige/asset value, highest cost), **limited editions** (prestige at lower cost, good for consistency), **open prints** (budget accents), and **commissions** (bespoke, made for your space — the strongest tool for a hero piece). Most strong programmes mix all four by tier.

Warning — provenance & rights: For every significant piece, keep authenticity/provenance documentation, and put in writing: ownership, the right to reproduce images (your marketing will want them), copyright (the artist usually keeps it), and what happens on resale or renovation.

'Try It Yourself — Hero shortlist (15 min)

Template — Shortlist

Hero opportunity #1: space = ____ type (original/edition/commission) = ____
 budget = ____ why it fits the narrative = ____
 Hero opportunity #2: ____
 Hero opportunity #3: ____

Curation is *editing*: a collection feels intentional when works share a thread (palette, theme, era, medium, idea). The test — could a guest sense a point of view *without reading a label*? If yes, you've curated. If no, you've decorated.

Module 4 — Placement, production & installation

Each zone has rules. **Lobby:** one hero, high impact, visible from the entrance. **Suites:** calmer, tactile, nothing that disturbs rest. **F&B:** characterful, durable against heat and grease. **Spa:** serene, often abstract, chosen for humidity. **Outdoor/pool:** weather-resilient sculpture.

Warning: The most common waste of money is great art, badly lit or wrongly sized. Budget for proper art lighting from day one, involve the lighting designer early, and **scale boldly** — under-sized art on a big wall looks timid and cheap.

A **signature installation** (sculptural, kinetic or digital) is often the single best ROI move — the photographed, shared, "you have to see it" moment. Plan it at design stage, with early engineering and a maintenance plan.

'Try It Yourself — Install readiness check

[] Art planned at design stage (not retrofit)
[] Dedicated art lighting budgeted
[] Scale checked against the actual wall/sightline
[] Fixings, power & structure confirmed with the build programme
[] Crating, transport, customs, framing, insurance & install crew planned

Any unchecked box is a delay or a cost overrun waiting to happen. Fix them now.

Module 5 — Impact, care & working with a consultant

What gets measured gets funded next time. You won't get perfect attribution — you don't need it. A handful of directional signals justifies the programme and guides the next.

Template — KPI tracker

Signal	How to track	Cadence
Social tags of artworks	Search location + hashtags	Monthly
Press / editorial pickups	Media monitoring	Quarterly
Review mentions of art	Review tool keyword search	Monthly
Dwell & spend in art spaces	POS + observation	Quarterly
Sales-gallery conversion (residences)	CRM	Per phase

Art is an asset that needs **care**: cleaning, condition checks, lighting upkeep, and a register of what you own, where it is, and its value. **Rotation** keeps repeat guests engaged — and is the foundation of an "art-as-a-service" model.

Tip — DIY vs hire: Do it yourself when scope, budget and stakes are modest and you have taste in-house. Bring in a consultant for hero pieces, commissions, multi-asset developments, tight construction timelines, or when art must perform commercially. A good consultant pays for themselves through better sourcing, fewer mistakes and faster delivery.

'Try It Yourself — Choose your path

This project is: [] DIY [] Consultant-led [] Hybrid
The single riskiest part is: _____ !' who owns it: _____

Your 7-Day Action Plan

- **Day 1** — Module 1 exercise: write your value case; pick your north-star lever.

- **Day 2** — Write your art narrative (Module 2).
- **Day 3** — Complete the space-by-space plan.
- **Day 4** — Set your three budget tiers.
- **Day 5** — Build your hero shortlist (Module 3).
- **Day 6** — Run the install-readiness check (Module 4).
- **Day 7** — Set up your KPI tracker and choose DIY / consultant / hybrid (Module 5).

Remember: 30 focused minutes a day beats one heroic weekend. Momentum compounds.

Cheat Sheet (tear-out)

- **Art is positioning, not decoration.** It moves rate, dwell, attention and asset value.
 - **Story first.** Narrative !' space-by-space plan !' budget tiers !' pieces.
 - **Spend on heroes.** 1–3 unforgettable works carry the brand.
 - **Plan early.** Art at design stage; light it properly; scale boldly.
 - **Protect the asset.** Provenance, image rights, care, rotation, a register.
 - **The test:** a guest should sense a point of view *without reading a label*.
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This workbook can be sold on your site as a paid programme or e-book — the practical, do-it-yourself format is exactly what makes it convert, and what leads readers naturally toward an Art Concept Sprint.

